

NovaCart

India's Intelligent Online Marketplace

Smart Shopping. Smarter Decisions.

Company Profile

Profit Recovery Analytics Platform

Profile Detail	Value
Version	1.0
Period	FY2025-FY2026
Prepared by	Aishi Dutta
Document type	Fictional Business Intelligence Case Study

Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India | Industry: E-commerce Marketplace

Document Information and Disclaimer

Field	Detail
Company name	NovaCart
Subtitle	India's Intelligent Online Marketplace
Tagline	Smart Shopping. Smarter Decisions.
Industry	E-commerce Marketplace
Headquarters	Bengaluru, Karnataka, India
Founded	2022
Business model	B2C Multi-Seller Marketplace
Employees	2,350
Registered customers	185,000
Active sellers	520
Suppliers	180
Products	24,500
Warehouses	8
Annual orders	550,000
Platforms	Website, Android and iOS

Important disclaimer. This document describes a fictional company created solely for educational and portfolio purposes. All names, figures, processes, business metrics and operational details are synthetic and do not represent any real organization.

This profile frames NovaCart as a portfolio-ready case study for analysing why profit can decline despite strong revenue, order and customer growth.

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Company Overview

NovaCart is a fictional Indian online marketplace connecting customers with verified sellers across electronics, fashion, grocery, furniture, books, beauty, sports, toys, office supplies, pet supplies and automotive accessories. The platform uses website, android and ios channels to support browsing, ordering, payments, delivery tracking, returns and customer support.

The operating model relies on seller listings, supplier relationships, 8 warehouses, logistics partners, payment partners and customer support teams. Customers can pay through common digital options such as UPI, cards, wallets and cash-on-delivery where eligible. The company has achieved nationwide delivery reach, but profitability is now under pressure because returns, marketing costs, delivery delays, operational exceptions and customer complaints are rising faster than operating leverage.

Company History

Year	Milestone
2022	Founded in Bengaluru with five categories and two warehouses.
2023	Expanded to ten states, launched Android and iOS apps and onboarded more than 150 sellers.
2024	Introduced seller advertising, loyalty benefits and automated warehouse allocation.
2025	Reached 185,000 customers, 520 sellers, 24,500 products and ₹185 Crore revenue.
2026	Launched the Profit Recovery Initiative.

Mission

Mission. To make online shopping affordable, reliable and customer-centric while empowering sellers across India through a technology-driven marketplace.

Vision

Vision. To become India's most trusted and data-driven online marketplace by delivering exceptional customer experiences and operational excellence.

Core Values

Value	Professional meaning
Customer First	Prioritise convenience, product confidence and responsive support in every decision.
Trust and Transparency	Maintain clear seller rules, honest pricing and traceable operational actions.
Data-Driven Decisions	Use reliable metrics to guide pricing, marketing, fulfilment and customer experience.
Operational Excellence	Reduce friction across warehouse, logistics, inventory and support workflows.
Seller Empowerment	Help verified sellers grow through fair policies, analytics and marketplace tools.
Continuous Innovation	Improve platforms, automation and analytics without losing operational discipline.

Business Model

NovaCart earns revenue by enabling marketplace transactions between customers and sellers while coordinating the fulfilment network around them. Customers create demand, sellers provide assortments, suppliers replenish inventory, warehouses process orders, logistics partners move shipments, payment partners complete transactions, marketing channels acquire traffic and customer support protects post-purchase trust.

- Customers generate demand, feedback, payment events and return signals.
- Sellers own assortment quality, pricing, dispatch discipline and product content.
- Warehouses and logistics partners convert marketplace demand into delivered orders.
- Finance, technology and analytics teams translate operational data into margin control.

NovaCart Marketplace Ecosystem

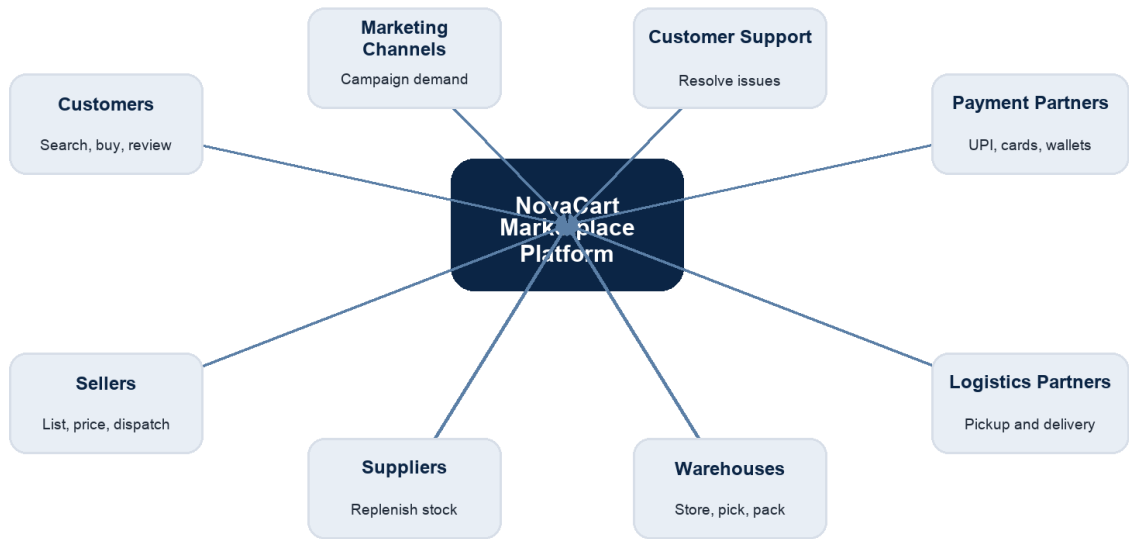


Figure 1. Simplified ecosystem view of NovaCart's marketplace operating model.

Product Category Portfolio - 24,500 Products

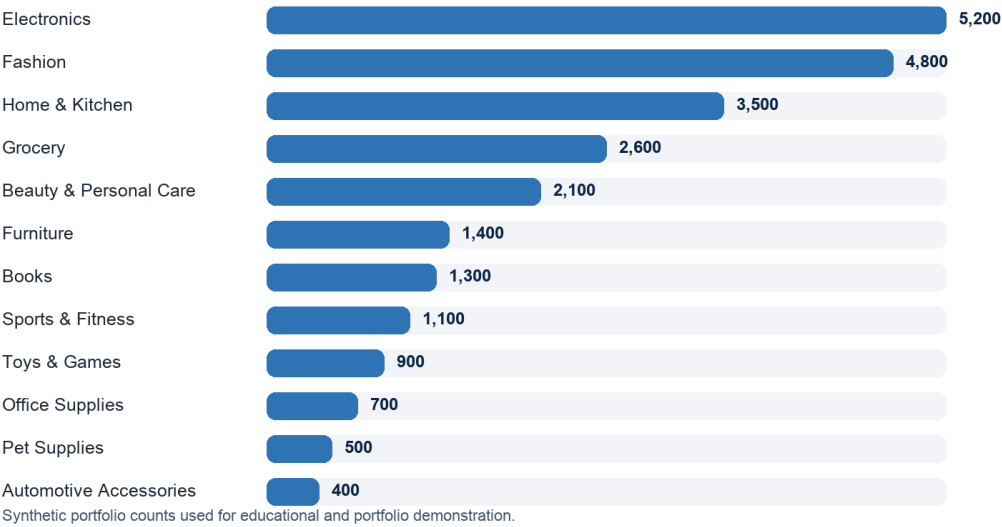


Figure 2. Product category counts. Total: 24,500.

Category	Products
Electronics	5,200
Fashion	4,800
Home & Kitchen	3,500
Grocery	2,600
Beauty & Personal Care	2,100
Furniture	1,400
Books	1,300
Sports & Fitness	1,100
Toys & Games	900
Office Supplies	700
Pet Supplies	500
Automotive Accessories	400

Category-specific challenges include high fashion returns due to size and fit, furniture shipping cost and damage exposure, electronics damage and warranty risk, and grocery delivery speed requirements. These category economics directly affect margin, fulfilment cost and customer satisfaction.

Organization Structure

NovaCart's fictional leadership structure avoids named employees and uses clear executive ownership for finance, operations, marketing, technology, people, marketplace growth and analytics.

Organization Structure

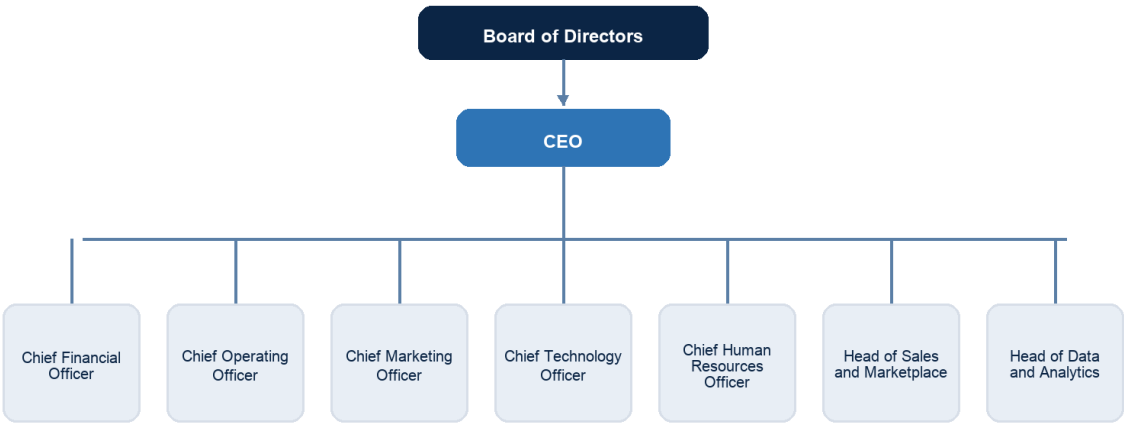


Figure 3. Executive hierarchy for the fictional NovaCart case study.

Departments

Department	Main responsibility	Key decisions	Important KPIs	Main data generated
Executive Management	Set company direction and governance	Portfolio priorities, risk appetite	Growth, profit, CSAT	Board packs, scorecards
Sales and Marketplace	Expand categories and sellers	Seller mix, commercial offers	GMV, seller activation	Seller funnel, listings
Marketing	Acquire and retain customers	Campaign mix, discount depth	CAC, ROI, retention	Campaign spend, cohorts
Finance	Own budgets and controls	Pricing guardrails, margin review	Profit margin, cash cycle	P&L, settlements
Operations	Coordinate fulfilment performance	SLA priorities, process fixes	Cycle time, backlog	Order events, exceptions
Warehouse	Receive, pick, pack and dispatch	Slotting, labour planning	Pick accuracy, dispatch SLA	Inventory scans, pick logs
Inventory	Balance supply and demand	Reorder levels, ageing actions	Stockout, ageing, turns	Stock ledger, forecasts
Logistics	Manage courier movement	Courier allocation, service recovery	OTD, RTO, damage	Tracking, delivery scans
Procurement	Source supplies and services	Vendor terms, replenishment	Cost, fill rate	POs, vendor records
Seller Management	Improve seller compliance	Quality actions, suspension review	Rating, return rate	Seller KPIs, claims
Customer Support	Resolve customer issues	Refund exceptions, escalations	TAT, ticket backlog	Tickets, complaint tags
Human Resources	Hire and develop teams	Staffing, training	Attrition, productivity	HRIS, attendance
Technology	Build and run platforms	Architecture, releases	Uptime, defects	Logs, incidents, releases
Data and Analytics	Turn data into decisions	Metrics, models, reporting cadence	Adoption, insight value	Dashboards, data marts

Warehouse Network - Eight Fulfilment Nodes

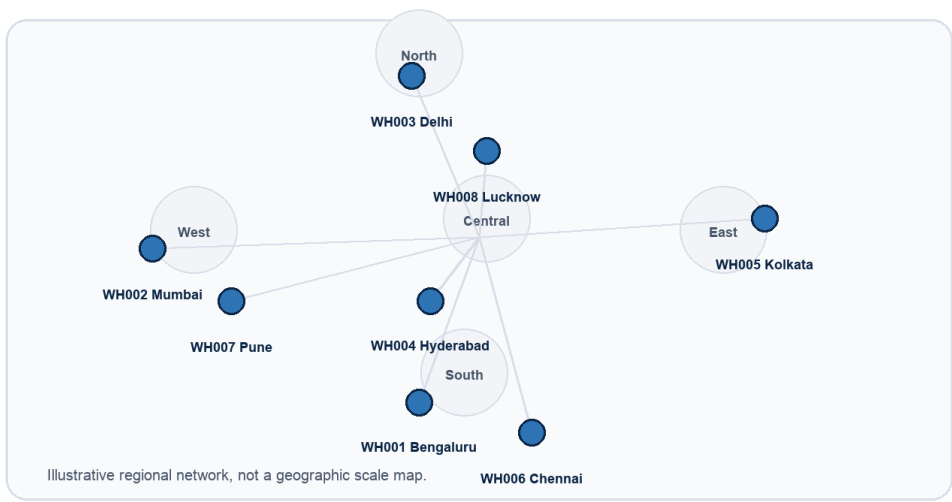


Figure 4. Fictional fulfilment node distribution for portfolio modelling.

Code	City	Region served	Storage capacity	Product focus	Operational importance
WH001	Bengaluru	South	55,000 sq ft	Electronics, grocery	Core southern fulfilment and technology test bed
WH002	Mumbai	West	70,000 sq ft	Fashion, home	High-volume metro and western corridor coverage
WH003	Delhi	North	68,000 sq ft	Electronics, books	Northern demand hub and returns consolidation point
WH004	Hyderabad	South-Central	48,000 sq ft	Beauty, office supplies	Balances south and central India service levels
WH005	Kolkata	East	42,000 sq ft	Books, fashion	Eastern fulfilment and seller pickup node
WH006	Chennai	South-East	46,000 sq ft	Grocery, beauty	Fast replenishment for coastal and tier-2 demand
WH007	Pune	West-Central	38,000 sq ft	Sports, toys	Overflow and seasonal campaign support
WH008	Lucknow	North-Central	35,000 sq ft	Furniture, automotive	Improves reach into central and northern cities

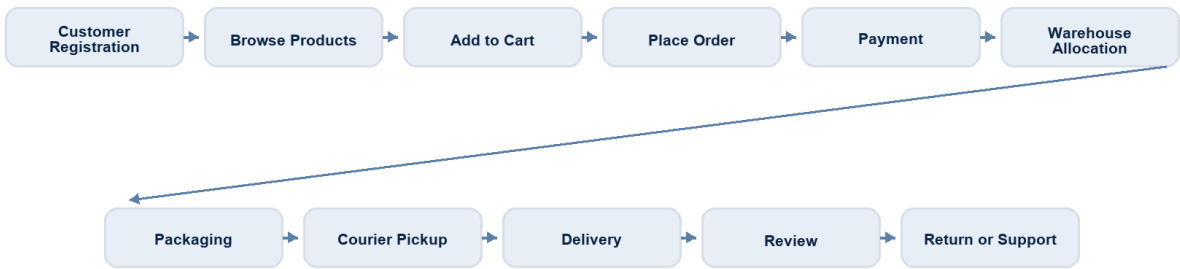
Logistics Network

NovaCart's illustrative logistics partners are Delhivery, Blue Dart, Xpressbees, Ekart Logistics and Ecom Express. These names are used only for illustrative purposes and do not imply any real partnership.

The logistics workflow covers courier assignment, pickup, transit, last-mile delivery, delivery confirmation, failed delivery handling and return pickup. Important KPIs include average delivery time, on-time delivery rate, first-attempt delivery rate, shipping cost per order, damage rate and return-to-origin rate. No partner-specific performance results are presented in this fictional profile.

Customer Journey

Customer Journey



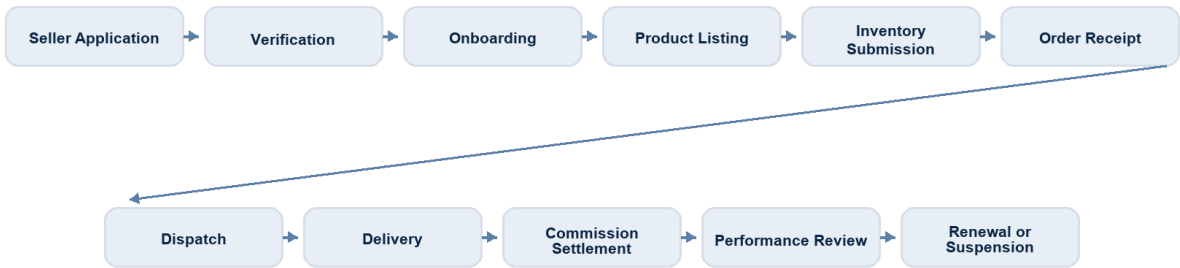
Each stage creates order, customer, operational, financial or service data used by the analytics team.

Figure 5. Customer journey from registration to review, return or support.

Main data generated across the journey includes registration source, search and browse behaviour, cart additions, order value, payment status, warehouse allocation, packaging scans, courier pickup, delivery confirmation, review sentiment, support ticket reasons and return outcomes.

Seller Journey

Seller Journey



Each stage creates order, customer, operational, financial or service data used by the analytics team.

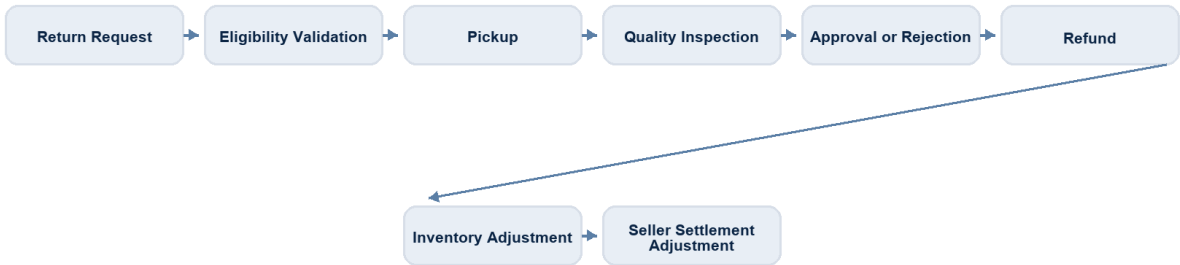
Figure 6. Seller journey from application to renewal or suspension.

Seller KPIs include seller rating, return rate, average dispatch time, cancellation rate, customer satisfaction, product defect rate and commission contribution. These indicators help NovaCart identify quality issues without treating a single metric as final evidence.

Return and Refund Policy

Returns are accepted within seven days for damaged product, wrong product delivered, manufacturing defect, not as described, size or fit issue for fashion and delivery delay.

Return and Refund Process



Each stage creates order, customer, operational, financial or service data used by the analytics team.

Figure 7. Fictional return and refund workflow.

Returns affect profit through reverse logistics, refund exposure, inventory quarantine, seller settlement adjustments, customer confidence and support workload. Analytics should separate controllable causes, such as seller quality and packaging defects, from customer preference behaviour.

Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Description	Primary Payer	Main Driver	Associated Risk
Marketplace commissions	Commission on seller transactions	Seller	Gross merchandise value	Margin pressure if discounting rises
Sponsored advertisements	Paid visibility and campaign slots	Seller	Seller ad adoption	Low ROI can reduce renewal
Premium seller subscriptions	Advanced tools and priority support	Seller	Seller retention	Churn if value is unclear
Delivery charges	Customer-paid or subsidised shipping	Customer	Order mix and distance	Abandonment if charges feel high
Platform service fees	Small fee for platform convenience	Customer	Order frequency	Sensitivity in low-value baskets
Fulfilment and warehouse fees	Storage, pick-pack and handling	Seller	Inventory volume	Ageing inventory cost
Promotional partnerships	Brand-funded campaigns and bundles	Brand or seller	Campaign performance	Overreliance on promotion

Fictional Technology Architecture

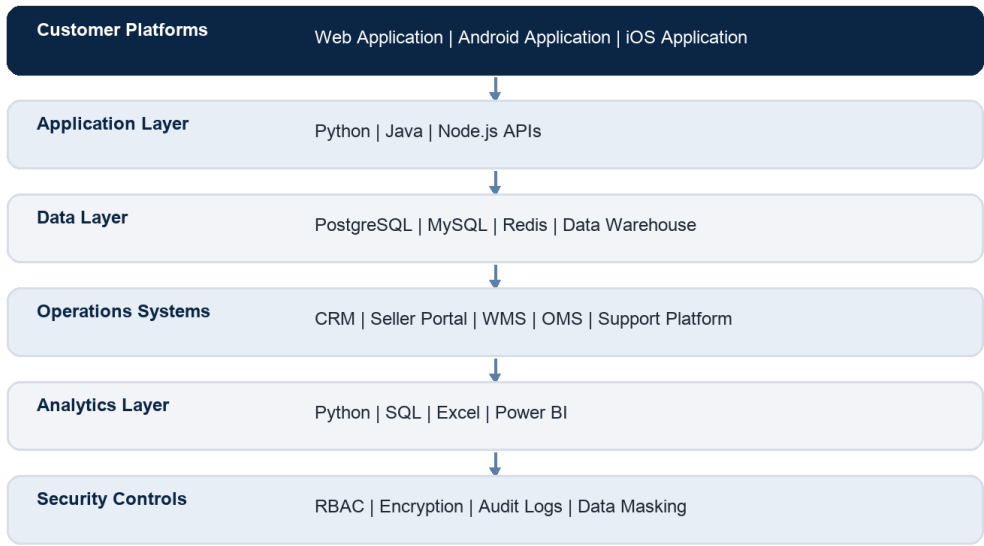


Figure 8. Fictional architecture showing customer, application, data, operations, analytics and security layers.

Layer	Fictional components
Customer Platforms	Web application; Android application; iOS application
Application Layer	Python; Java; Node.js
Databases	PostgreSQL; MySQL; Redis
Cloud and Storage	Cloud environment; object storage; data warehouse
Analytics	Python; SQL; Excel; Power BI
Operations	CRM; seller portal; warehouse management system; order management system; customer support platform
Security	Role-based access control; encryption; audit logs; data masking

FY2025 Business Snapshot

Revenue Growth 31%	Order Growth 28%	Customer Growth 22%
Annual Revenue ₹185 Crore	Annual Profit ₹16.5 Crore	Profit Margin Approximately 9%
Registered Customers 185,000	Active Sellers 520	Products 24,500
Warehouses 8	Annual Orders 550,000	Return Rate 12%
Average Delivery Time 4.8 days	Customer Satisfaction 3.9 out of 5	Repeat Purchase Rate 34%
Marketing ROI 2.4x	Customer Acquisition Cost ₹1,280	

These values are synthetic FY2025 assumptions for the portfolio case study and remain consistent throughout the profile.

Current Business Crisis

The following year-over-year changes are fictional case-study assumptions designed to support a profit recovery analytics exercise.

Business signal	Year-over-year change
Revenue	Increased by 31%
Orders	Increased by 28%
Customers	Increased by 22%
Profit	Decreased by 18%
Marketing spend	Increased by 42%
Product returns	Increased by 29%
Average delivery time	Increased from 2.9 to 4.8 days
Customer satisfaction	Decreased from 4.6 to 3.9
Customer support tickets	Increased by 36%

Possible Areas for Investigation

The analytics team should investigate discounting, return costs, marketing inefficiency, delivery delays, seller quality, inventory imbalance, warehouse inefficiency, shipping costs, customer churn and refund leakage. These are investigation areas, not confirmed causes.

Profit Recovery Initiative

Objective. To identify the principal drivers of profit decline despite increasing revenue and recommend measurable actions across sales, marketing, logistics, inventory, sellers and customer experience.

CEO statement. "Our company is growing faster than ever, but profitability is falling. We need to understand why this is happening, identify the operational and financial bottlenecks and provide actionable recommendations backed by data."

Initiative workstream	Management focus
Profitability analysis	Margin bridge, contribution leakage and category-level profit drivers
Sales performance	Demand mix, basket quality, discount dependence and repeat-order behaviour
Marketing ROI	Campaign payback, channel efficiency and customer acquisition cost reduction
Seller performance	Seller quality, dispatch discipline, return exposure and commission yield
Warehouse efficiency	Pick-pack productivity, allocation accuracy, backlog and exception handling
Delivery performance	Service-level recovery, courier allocation logic and last-mile reliability
Returns and refunds	Return reasons, inspection outcomes, refund leakage and settlement impact
Customer retention	Complaint themes, satisfaction recovery and loyalty economics
Inventory optimization	Stock availability, ageing inventory, replenishment accuracy and fulfilment cost
Executive reporting	Single source of truth for weekly decisions, risks and KPI ownership

Company Goals FY2026

KPI	Current	Target	Strategic rationale	Owner	Measurement method
Revenue Growth	31%	40%	Scale profitable demand	Executive / Marketing	Monthly revenue dashboard
Profit Margin	9%	14%	Recover contribution quality	Finance	P&L and margin bridge
Return Rate	12%	Below 8%	Reduce reverse logistics cost	Seller / Operations	Return reason analytics
Average Delivery Time	4.8 days	3 days	Improve experience and repeat orders	Logistics	Courier SLA dashboard
Customer Satisfaction	3.9/5	4.6/5	Restore customer trust	Support	Post-delivery CSAT
Repeat Purchase Rate	34%	50%	Grow retention economics	Marketing	Cohort repeat analysis
Marketing ROI	2.4x	3.5x	Shift spend to efficient campaigns	Marketing	Campaign ROI model
Customer Acquisition Cost	₹1,280	₹950	Lower paid acquisition burden	Marketing / Finance	CAC waterfall report

Closing Summary

NovaCart is designed as a realistic fictional marketplace profile for business intelligence portfolio work. The company shows the classic tension between top-line growth and bottom-line pressure: revenue, orders and customers are expanding, while returns, delivery delays, marketing spend and support issues are weakening profit quality.

The Profit Recovery Initiative gives analysts a structured setting to connect commercial, operational and customer-experience data. A strong analytics response would quantify where profit leakage occurs, prioritize action owners and convert insight into measurable FY2026 targets across margin, returns, delivery speed, satisfaction, repeat purchases, marketing efficiency and acquisition cost.